

Electronic products policy to now focus on exports

NITI Aayog, the government of India's premier policy institute, has dumped its 'Make in India Strategy for Electronic Products' and has floated another policy, which is more export-oriented and favours developing coastal economic zones. The previous policy paper faced opposition from Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology, earlier Department of Electronics and IT (DeITY), as well as reservations from other stakeholders mainly because of its domestic focus and emphasis on semiconductors.

India's domestic consumption of electronics hardware was US\$ 63.6 billion in 2014-15, with imports

accounting for 58 per cent of the total. NITI Aayog had initially come out with a draft policy that sought to attract global electronics manufacturers to set up units in India and give a push to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 'Make in India' project. The draft policy suggested a ten-year tax holiday for companies investing over US\$ 1 billion in electronics manufacturing or creating 20,000 jobs in India.

The same has now been junked in favour of the proposal to set up coastal economic zones for labour-intensive sectors in the country, much along the lines of China, to enable manufacturers to tap overseas markets without much difficulty.

Worldwide semiconductor capital spending to decline 0.3 per cent in 2016

Worldwide semiconductor capital spending is projected to decline 0.3 per cent in 2016, to US\$ 64.6 billion, according to Gartner Inc. This is up slightly from the estimated 0.7 per cent decline in Gartner's previous quarterly forecast. The market is expected to return to growth in 2017, increasing 7.4 per cent.

David Christensen, senior research analyst at Gartner, has said, "Outlook for equipment has improved significantly as logic manufacturers

focus their spending on ramping fabs for the introduction of high-volume ten-nanometre production in 2017 and memory producers are focusing on the move to 3D NAND flash."

China remains something of a wild card, after the announcement of multiple fab projects that will aid overall growth through the end of the decade, while a stronger US dollar in 2016 will remain a key factor in determining revenue growth of semiconductor manufacturers.

Solar installations in India cross 8.6GW

Cumulative solar installations in India have reached 8643MW as of September 2016. Mercom is forecasting solar installations to reach approximately 4.8GW for calendar year 2016. So far, installations in calendar year 2016 have reached 3.8GW.

Approximately 500MW of solar has been installed in about a month since Mercom last reported installation figures for India. Four states have crossed the 1GW solar installation mark. Out of the 8.6GW installed so far, Tamil Nadu,

On The Move

Cognizant appoints Rajeev Mehta as president

IT major Cognizant has appointed company veteran Rajeev Mehta as its new president. He replaces Gordon Coburn, who has resigned from the company. Mehta joined Cognizant in 1997.

Lt Gen Chandeel appointed as president of IETE

Lt Gen (Dr) AKS Chandeel, PVSM, AVSM, (Retd) has been appointed as president, Institution of Electronics and Telecommunication Engineers, India. Established in 1953, the organisation is devoted to the advancement of electronics, telecommunications, computers, information technology and other related disciplines. The government of India has recognised it as Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation (SIRO) and has also notified it as an Educational Institution of National Importance.

Cyient announces SVP, semiconductor business unit head

Cyient, a global provider of engineering, manufacturing, networks and operations services and analytics solutions, has announced the appointment of Suman Narayan as senior vice president and head for semiconductor business unit. Narayan has over two decades of experience in the semiconductor industry.

First woman director takes charge at BEL

Anandi Ramalingam has taken charge as director (marketing), at Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL). She was general manager heading Military Communication Strategic Business Unit at BEL's Bengaluru Complex prior to her elevation.

Vinod Sawhny steps down as CEO, Reliance Communications

Reliance Communication chief executive officer (CEO) Vinod Sawhny has stepped down from the post, citing personal reasons. The company has mentioned that William (Bill) Barney and Gurdeep Singh will now function as acting co-chief executives of the company with immediate effect.